

DIE ENTSCHTANNING: GRUNDSAUDAAG/FREIDSEGE KANNSEGE/BUTZEMANNSEGE 4. HANNING, 2018



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REV - D 7

Honoring: Freid, Gewwern (Gefjon), die Grundsau, der Butzemann. Idise, Matronae

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune intoned thrice: Baerke, Gewwe, Odem, Loch

Die Heiliching - The Hallowing

*Kell un Schpindel, weiht daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Trowel and Spindle, make holy this altar and this place
Beschitzt uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe
Protect us with the Power of the Deities
Bei Wudan un Freid fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue
By Wudan and Freid to build the community
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeet un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde
By Ziu and Zisa to uphold justice and frith
Bei Frey un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu schneide un zu sammle
By Frey and Freya to cut and collect the bounty
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtiche.
By Dunner and Siwwa to empower the folk
Bei der Fraa Holle fer es Volk zu erneire
By Fraa Holle to renew the folk
Bei der Gewwern fer es Land zu bluge.
By Gewwern to plow the land
Der Blug brecht es Land uff, um die Wohldaat aazublanze.
The plow breaks the land up to plant the bounty.
Die Schpindel macht die Schnur, die uns zammebinnt un die Wunde
aaheelt.
The Spindle makes the string that binds us together and that heals wounds
'S iss es Lewesraad, zu effne, zuzumache un widderhaerzuschtelle.
It is the Wheel of Life, to open, to close, and to restore
Kell un Schpindel, weiht daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Trowel and Spindle, make holy this altar and this place!*

Heel!

Heel!

Heel!

Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

Heit sammle mir uns do, fer die Freid un die Gewwern zu ehre. Mir ehre aa die Idise un alle die weibliche Schaffergreft.

Heel zu de Ziewe!

Heel zu de Wichde!

Heel zum Land!

Heel zu der Gmeeschaft!

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

Invocations to Freid, Gewwern (Gefjon), and the Idise will be made both in Deutsch and in English.

Liewi Haerrin Freid

Allmutter, Haerdziebin

Weib vum Wudan, Mutter vum Balder

Kosmische Naehern,

Schliessehalderin

Beliebt Schitzern

Heit bedanke mir uns Dir!

Kumm mol heit zu uns,

Un sei unseri geehrt Gaschtin!

Heele!

Liewi Haerrin Gewwern

Bannerin vum Blug,

Mudder vun de Dene

Farichtlosi Gewwerin

Mir bedanke uns Dir!

Kumm mol heit zu uns,

Un sei unseri geehrt Gaschtin!

Liewe Idise

Weibliche Schaffergreft

Draagerinne vum Lewe

Fiehrerinne nooch die Zukunft

Kummt mol heit zu deine Noochkummer

Dear Lady Freid

All-Mother, Hearth Goddess

Wife of Wudan, Mother of Balder

Cosmic Seamstress

Keeper of the Keys

Beloved Protectress

Today we thank You!

Come today to us

and be our honored guest!

Hail!

Dear Lady Gefjon

Charmer of the Plow

Mother of the Danes

Fearless giver

We thank You!

Come today to us

And be our honored guest!

Dear Matriarchal Spirits

Feminine creative energies

Bearers of Life

Guides to the future

Come today to your descendants

Un sei ihre geehrte Gaschtinne!

And be their honored guests.

Heele!

Hail!

Die Leses - The Readings

Es Opfer un Die Eed - The Offering and the Oaths

Losset uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar adder in 's Feier yetz schtelle

Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz voraa.

If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar, or, later, into the fire.

If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.

Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - The Hallowing of the Offerings

Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

Der Sege - The Blessing

When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):

Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns

From the gods to the Earth to us

Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Gedder

From us to the Earth to the gods

'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk

A gift for a gift.

Heele!

Hail!

Der Kannsege - Ceremony of the Corn

Der Butzemannsege - Ceremony of the Scarecrow

The Butzemann receives the Breath of Life and the plant spirits are awakened.

Zum Schluss - In Closing

Zu de Wichde - To the Wights

Der Grenslaaf - The Border Walk

We walk the Butzemann around the perimeter of his turf.

RUNNING THEMES OF ENTSCHTANNING OBSERVANCES

ENTSCHTANNING ("EMERGENCE")

- * Twelve-night observance featuring the items listed below.
- * Emergence from darkness into light
- * Emergence from the murky unknown of what is before or between lives into life
- * Emergence of the self identity from non-existence
- * Emergence of consciousness from unconsciousness or oblivion
- * Wild Hunt depictions after New Year are colorful and vibrant; Mardi Gras and Fasching likely have shared roots
- * Fertility rites, including the root of the Faschnachtskuche (or Fettkuche) a Lenten tradition among the Deitsch but a reflection of pregnancy in older traditions.

GROUNDHOG

- * Feminine figure in Deitsch lore
- * Otherworldly messenger
- * Emerging from burrow representing emergence of consciousness from unconsciousness
- * Reflection of relationship to animals
- * Resourcefulness

FREID

- * Motherhood
- * Cosmic Wisdom and application thereof
- * Spinning the material used in the fabric of Wurt
- * Time
- * Security
- * Home, Hearth, Garden
- * Belonging; Gemietlichkeet
- * Provides feminine aspects to garden
- * Consumption of Fettkuche on the last Friday of Entschtanning

GEWWERN

- * Power of feminine energy
- * Creativity and resourcefulness
- * Matronae
- * Charming of the Plow

IDISE

- * Matriarchal and feminine energies and contributions
- * Continuity of life
- * Belonging; Gemietlichkeet
- * Matronae
- * "Fairy godmother" concept
- * Aid in evolution of following generations

BUTZEMANN

- * That which is created; child of last year's crop
- * "Zombie plant spirits"; plant energies can lie dormant and be awakened
- * Emerging and re-emerging life
- * Importance of oaths
- * Continuity of life
- * Hospitality, Stewardship, Zusaagpflicht

- * Relationship to plants
- * Provides masculine aspects to garden
- * Father of the coming crop
- * Establishment of identity

WAAHRA

- * Hearing oaths
- * Holding oath-takers to their words
- * Aiding in sorting out disputes among those who have oaths to one another

Topics for Discussion

Well folks, Punxsutawney Phil has stuck his nose out, and soon everyone will be talking about his prediction for an early spring in 2017.

Groundhog Day starts a twelve-day festival for which the only name we have is Fasching. Although that term is associated with post-conversion pre-Lenten practices, the roots of the parades and revelry (e.g., Mardi Gras) are in Heathen era traditions. Even Ash Wednesday is loaded with Heathen elements. The ashes that are spread on the forehead represent a reminder of mortality to Christians, but there is some evidence that the practice's origins were pre-Christian and represented instead a protective mark. Also, the word Lent simply means "spring" and is akin to the Deutsch word Lenzing, which is a regional (and official Urglaawe) name for the month of March.

1). The groundhog is similar to Ratatosk, the squirrel that runs up and down the Tree of Life, Yggdrasil, bringing news of the nine worlds. Thus, the groundhog is the otherworldly messenger. Anyone who is familiar with groundhog burrows knows that they are intricately designed with multiple openings. Our ancestors saw an analogy between the burrow and the Nine Worlds. The groundhog brings news and prognostication. For an agricultural people, the short-term weather is naturally something that the people would like to know, which is probably why that particular feature was passed on to the wider American culture.

2). The day to honor the Idise (matriarchal spirits) and to celebrate feminine creative energies. Braucherei reports the day as being sacred to the "Hearth Goddess," whom we know to be Freid. The choice of this time for this observance is that we're starting to see the first signs of the return of the fertility of the soil. This is the birth of the new.

3). Akin to the second item is the creation of the Butzemann. The Butzemann is a scarecrow, who is spiritually activated via a Braucherei ceremony called the Ceremony of the Corn. In Urglaawe, our ceremonies typically consist of Sege (blot), Schmaus (feast), and Sammel (sumble), but for Grundsaudaag, we add the Ceremony of the Corn in as well. Butzemenner are still widely used (beyond the typical scarecrow concept) in the Deitscherei (Pennsylvania Dutch Country). There are numerous superstitions surrounding the Butzemann, particularly that he must be burned by Allelieweziel (Halloween). It is considered the height of bad luck to leave a Butzemann after Allelieweziel. The results of doing so are the things that are used to frighten small children into staying in bed on Christmas Eve lest they be kidnapped by the Butzemann or a Butz.

4). Also akin to Freid is the cleaning of the hearth. On this day, we are to clean out our hearths, fireplaces, candleholders, or anything else that fire burns in (most particularly for heat, but since many folks don't have fireplaces anymore, adjusting with candles keeps with the spirit of the tradition). The fire is to be rekindled with birch (also sacred to Freid). The rune Berkano is featured in conjunction with the birch as it relates both to the current state of death (winter) and to the forthcoming promise of rebirth (spring). We are now beginning the time of gestation, both in the thought and in action, as we prepare the way for the spring germination. Between now and Walpurgisnacht (April 30), we are to conduct our spring cleaning.

5). Tradition holds that the first travelers with Holle and Wudan on the Furious Host (Wild Hunt) begin to return to the land at this time, if the groundhog predicts an early end to winter. The belief in Braucherei is that this is the time in which the veil between the physical and spiritual realms is almost as thin as it is on Allelieweziel, so it's considered an advantageous time to interact with ancestors and to help trapped or lost souls to cross over. Most Urglaawer believe in a life-death-rebirth cycle rather than the Valhalla lore to the north. My sense is that Braucherei, as an Elder tradition, brought forth the rebirth concepts from a time prior to the Valhalla/Folkvang/Ragnarok concepts development to the north. Also, as a primarily agricultural people, the life-death-rebirth cycle is so engrained in both the collective conscious and the collective unconscious that it is culturally relevant. While we do believe in the Doom of the Gods, most Urglaawer do not believe that the souls of those who died in battle go to Valhalla to await Ragnarok. Instead, the cosmic day and cosmic night cycles will run and the universe will end with the battle between the deities and their foes. Urglaawe is not centralized, so beliefs do vary from person to person, so your beliefs certainly may vary. Heck, none of us will know till we die anyway. Though my work using Braucherei's journeying method (time-cord work) has supported the Urglaawe view, I guess cultural context does matter and different practitioners using different methods can find results that support their path's beliefs. There's room for us all. :)

6). Many Anglo-Saxon and Norse Heathens observe the Charming of the Plow, or the Disting, at this time of the year, which provides an excellent opportunity to honor the goddess Gefjon, for whom we now have, through backformation, the name of Gewwern in Deutsch.

Deity and Fertility Associations

While we're familiar with the significance of the solar cycle's equinoxes and solstices, the cross quarter days' significance is that of the green living world. Thus, this is an important fertility and pastoral holiday.

As the Earth prepares for renewal, we celebrate the creative power of women. This is also a time of cleaning and purging. Cleansing and purifying the home before Feb. 2 is not too hard; however, cleaning it is a different matter. We are called to do both at this time. This is where the concept of Spring Cleaning comes from.

This relationship of the holiday to the home leads us to associate Groundhog Day with Freid, but the Urglaawe understanding of Freid differs from that of some other branches of Heathenry.

Freid

Freid is seen as spinning the very material from which the Norns weave our Wurt (or Wyrð, as many other Heathens would know the term). This to us places Her so high in the Cosmic scheme that She is essentially a goddess of time, energy, and matter as well as a goddess of the home. We honor Her at the end of Yuul in recognition of Her association with time, but at Groundhog Day, we honor Her creative power and Her protection of home and hearth.

As part of the cleaning, the fire was allowed to go out in the hearth. A new fire was to be started with birch. This relates the day with the rune Berkano we begin to draw associations with other goddesses (Holle, Freya, and others) and with maternal ancestors, etc.

The Groundhog and Der Butzemann

Many people are aware that the majority of secular American Christmas traditions were inherited from the Pennsylvania Germans, but Christmas is hardly a unique case.

Most everyone has heard of Groundhog Day. Many people snicker at the concept of a prognosticating rodent sticking its head up through the ground (usually by compulsion in Punxsutawney) and dismiss it as one of the more bizarre bits of Americana that we encounter throughout the year.

The truth is far more complicated. This is an observance that has changed over the centuries from the badger in German lands to the groundhog in the Deitscherei (Pennsylvania Dutch Country).

Groundhog burrows are complicated networks of tunnels with many entrances and exits. In some ways, the burrows can be conceptualized in a manner similar to that of the Nine Worlds of Teutonic mythology.

Thus, the groundhog represents those who travel among the nine worlds throughout the period of the Wild Hunt, which begins on Allelieweziel (Halloween). The return of this otherworld traveler serves as a metaphor for the return of many spirits and wights from the Wild Hunt and back into the soil. While Holle Herself has not yet completed the Wild Hunt, the return of these entities sets the stage for the next few months.

Brauchers and Braucherins work to help the end of their journey be comfortable and beneficial to the spirits, and the spirits return the favor with fertility and prosperity. If one should have any ancestor spirits whom are suspected to be in need of help, this is the optimal time to work with them. An elderberry bush (Hollerbeier or Hollebeer in Pennsylvania German, named for Holle) can serve as an effective vehicle for communication. These are practices that Urglaawe shares with Braucherei.

Even in modern days, Brauchers hold the Ceremony of the Corn (der Kannsege). The corn from last year is blessed and its power called upon to watch over the coming year's crops in the form of a Butzemann. "Butzemann" literally translates as "scarecrow," but there are layers of spirituality imbued in the Butzemann in Deitsch culture and in Urglaawe that are lacking in modern American culture.

The Butzemann holds the soul of the corn, and it is essentially the "father" of this year's corn (or any other) crop. There are several rites and rituals that surround the Butzemann, but the most important are his placing prior to planting and his sacrifice at the end of the growing season. In fact, to let a Butzemann stand past Allelieweziel (Halloween) is dangerous, which we will revisit between the Harvest Home and Allelieweziel.

Gewwern

Gefjon, whom we call Gewwern, is seen as the mother of Denmark, and, in an ironic twist, is closely associated with virgins and plows. King Gylfi of Sweden promised a disguised Gefjon as much land as She could plow in one night. She transformed Her sons into and plowed the Danish island of Zealand off from Sweden, thus creating the Swedish Lake Vänern. There are some linguistic links between Gefjon's name, which denotes giving, and Nordic words for marriage.

There are also linguistic links to the Matronae group called the Alagabiae (Matronis Alagabiabus), to whom an inscription on a votive stone dating from the 4th century A.D. from Bürgel near Solingen, West Germany (CIL XIII 8529) is dedicated. The name, which means 'All-giver', presents a Germanic counterpart to the partially Celticized matron name Ollogabiae. It is possible that the same matrons were venerated under both names among the mixed Germanic-Celtic population on the Lower Rhine (Source: Simek's "Dictionary of Northern Mythology"). She is seen as one of the goddesses in Freid's retinue, and there are some linguistic connections between Her name and Freid and Freya, too, which is interesting given that Freid is of the Ase (Aesir) and Freya is of the Wane (Vanir). Gefjon is considered Aesir.

Also interesting is that Holle and Berchta are also said to carry plows.

Zealand Maps (Credits to Heidi and Kevin for the idea)



The map on the left shows the island of Sjælland, or Zealand, which is where the capital of Denmark, Copenhagen, is located. The map on the right shows lake Vänern. Some folks, given erosion and other physical forces, see similarities that lead them to conclude that Gefjon plowed Zealand out of Vänern.

Der Kannsege
(adapted for use outside of Braucherei guilds)

The Butzemann should already be constructed out of plant remnants from the prior season. If you use only one type of plant for the construction (e.g., corn), you may edit the calls to relate only to that specific plant. In my case, I use many different plant remnants, so the calls refer to "plants."

Before the Butzemann is completed (or sewn up), I insert a heart (cut from paper or cardboard) and various prayer slips (with my own expressions of goodwill and prosperity) and rune slips (with any combination (or all) of Ingwaz, Jera, Othala, Fehu, Ansuz, Berkano, and Laguz).

A knowledge of runes is most helpful. Appropriate runes can be intoned or envisioned at any time throughout the rite. However, for the purposes of this adapted rite, I only am mentioning the runes that are central to the function of an Urglaawe Kannsege.

There is an element of otherworldly travel involved in this adapted rite.

----- Incantation -----

Daer Bau, Desi Luft (This Earth, This Air)

Daer Bau, Desi Luft

Daer Bau, Desi Luft

Ich bitt vun de Ziewe die Erlaawing, fer die hallich Scheid neizuschteige. (I request of the deities the permission to step into the heavenly partition).

Ich schteh mit eem Fuus uff em Hatzholz un schteig mit zwettem in die Weschtbledder nei. (I stand with one foot in Hatzholz (Midgard) and step, with the second, into the West Leaves).

Ich ruf zu de mitleidiche Blanzeseele reizukumme, fer ihre Nochkummer auszuhelfe. (I call to the compassionate plant spirits [change if using only one plant, e.g., corn spirits] to come to the aid of their descendants).

Ich bin die Brick. (I am the bridge).

Ich bin die Brick.

Ich bin die Brick

[Repeat in multiples of three as often as you feel is needed]

At this point, you do not want to close out your connection to the West Leaves, but you can speak freely in Deutsch or English.

Here is where you can state in more detail to the spirits what your purpose is (for them to meld with the static spirits in order to awaken them within the plant material of the Butzemann, to give the breath of life to the Butzemann, etc).

Your promise is to name and to take care of the Butzemann, to honor his purpose, to make offerings to the spirits within him, to aid him in the care of his "children," etc. THIS IS AN OATH AND YOU MUST ABIDE BY YOUR WORDS.

Most important: you must promise to relieve him of his duties at an appropriate time and to help the melded spirit within him to return to the otherworld. THIS IS AN OATH. IT MUST BE KEPT. HE MUST BE BURNED BETWEEN THE AUTUMN EQUINOX AND ALLELIEWEZEIEL (Halloween).

----- Butzemannsege -----

Ich geb zu dir der Ochdem. Loss dei Megge aufaerweckt sei.
(I give to you the breath of life. May your main be resuscitated.)

(Breathe onto the "mouth" of the Butzemann).

Intone the "Ansuz" rune (known also as "Antwatt" in Deutsch) and draw the rune with your right thumb over where the mind's eye would be on the Butzemann. If skilled in otherworldly experience or in runes, do this repeatedly until you sense that you have received the rune back in response from the now-activated spirit.

Alternate: Intone the Ansuz, Berkano, and Laguz runes while drawing the runes upon the Butzemann.

Now give a name to the Butzemann. There is a traditional naming convention. Please see <http://tinyurl.com/crjohmm> for more information. The only thing I would add is that a first-generation Butzemann would have the appellation of "der Nei" follow his name (if his name is Arnold, he'd be 'Arnold der Nei').

BE SURE TO KEEP A RECORD OF HIS NAME. YOU WILL NEED IT WHEN HE IS BURNED. In fact, consider calling him by his full name frequently. The naming serves as recognition of, and respect for, the plant spirits as beings.

Der Butzemannsege watt gschlosse.
The Butzemannsege is closed.

----- Closing -----

After the activation rite is completed, it is important to serve as a bridge back.

Ich bedank mich zu de Ziewe un de mitleidiche Blanzeseele. Ich schteh noch zwische em Hatzholz un de Weschtbledder, fer die zerickzuschteige. (I thank the deities and the compassionate plant spirits. I stand still between Midgard and the West Leaves for them to go back).

Ich bin die Brick. (I am the bridge)

Ich bin die Brick.

Ich bin die Brick.

Der Kannsege watt gschlosse.

The Ceremony of the Corn is closed.

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